

GENERATION SHIP

Player Booklet — Mission Overview

Your Mission

Humanity is sending a generation ship to the star Proxima Centauri, about 4.2 light-years away. With the propulsion technology conceivable today, the journey takes around 60,000 years — more than 2,000 generations. Nobody on board will live to see the arrival. And yet, today, you have to decide how this journey can succeed.

Your task as a group: together, develop a concept for how life on board can work across all those generations — and plan what the ship needs to look like to make that possible.

What Your Concept Should Answer

- How are decisions made on board, and who gets a say?
- How does important knowledge (technical, cultural, scientific) survive for millennia?
- How do you deal with conflict and differing interests on board?
- How is it ensured that the mission is actually carried through to the end — even by generations who never made the decision to set out?

Keep your concept in note form (e.g. on a poster) — you'll present it briefly at the end.

Your Second Task: the Blueprint

In addition to your concept, you'll use the enclosed three-page blueprint to plan how the ship is divided up:

- The engines are already drawn in on Deck 3 — you don't need to add those yourselves.
- All other rooms are drawn empty: fill in which room goes where (see room overview below).
- Doors are not drawn in yet — draw them in yourselves, wherever you think they make sense.
- Your layout should match your concept: a group that values community will need large shared spaces, for example; a group that values control might plan differently.

Room Overview — These Areas Must Be Included

Command Bridge / Control Center	Steering, navigation and communication for the ship — where all the important information comes together.
Living and Sleeping Quarters	Retreat spaces for the crew; need to be enough for many consecutive generations.
Food Production	Growing, raising or otherwise producing food — some ongoing form of food production.
Water Treatment	Producing and recycling drinking water in a closed loop.
Air & Life Support	Oxygen production, air purification and climate control.

Medical Station	Treatment, care, births and health provision across generations.
Knowledge & Education Archive	Library, school and data storage — so knowledge isn't lost.
Workshop & Technical Area	Repairs, spare-parts manufacturing, maintenance of onboard systems.
Waste & Recycling System	Reusing materials in a largely closed system.
Communal & Recreation Area	Meeting spaces for social life, culture, exercise and relaxation.
Storage	Reserves for emergencies and equipment that isn't needed all the time.

Optional — depending on your concept, you can add further rooms, for example:

Quarantine / Isolation Room	For cases of illness, to contain outbreaks in a closed society.
Place of Remembrance	A way of dealing with death and memory on board — unavoidable over millennia.
Childcare / On-site School	In addition to the education archive, a place for everyday life with children.

Good luck on your journey to Proxima Centauri!